



The Preparedness Manual

Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts

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Introduction

Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts is among the most prominent players in the global luxury hospitality sector.

The group was founded in 1961 by Isadore Sharp, a Canadian architect and entrepreneur who had a clear vision for a new concept of luxury hospitality: elegant facilities combined with attentive, personalized service.

Its core activities center on the management of luxury hotels, resorts, and branded residential properties. What makes Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts stand out among the competition is its exceptional service delivered through high-quality standards, personalized guest experiences, and consistency across diverse geographic markets.

The first hotel opened in Toronto to accommodate the growing number of business travellers, driven by the rapid expansion of international mobility and air transportation during that period. The project proved successful, allowing the company to grow from a single-property operation into one of the most well-established and globally recognized brands in the premium lodging industry.

Today, the company's presence in 47 countries with more than 100 facilities underscores its extensive international reach and position in the upper segment of the hospitality industry.

Over the years, the company pursued a strategic expansion and diversification process. While its core remains rooted in hospitality management, Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts has expanded into adjacent sectors, including resort destinations, branded residences, private aviation, and yacht chartering services. This evolution shifted the group's position from a hotel operator to a global luxury lifestyle brand, increasing the complexity of its operations, which now require coordination across multiple service areas, stakeholders, and geographic contexts.

Diversification is a function of the environment in which Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts operates.

The luxury hospitality sector is influenced by a wide range of external factors, including macroeconomic fluctuations, geopolitical instability, evolving travel patterns, technological advancements, sustainability pressures, and shifting consumer expectations. In this highly dynamic and globalized context, competitive advantage is increasingly determined by intangible elements such as brand reputation, service quality, reliability, and trust.

Such environmental pressure contributed to the company's strategic choice to diversify its operations and enter adjacent luxury sectors, where personalized experiences and exclusivity play an increasingly central role.

One aspect of Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts worth mentioning is its business model. Instead of owning most of its properties, the company mainly manages

them. This strategy creates a high level of interdependence between multiple stakeholders, making them a key element to manage.

Guests represent the most visible and revenue-generating group among the stakeholder ecosystem. Their satisfaction and trust are fundamental to the brand's success. Employees play an equally strategic role, as service quality in the hospitality sector is directly influenced by their competence, professionalism, and interpersonal skills. Property owners and investors are likewise central due to the nature of its management model.

Additional members of the stakeholder ecosystem include suppliers, travel agents, regulatory authorities, local communities, media organizations, and strategic partners.

The company must continuously ensure alignment, governance, and coordination among this complex network, making effective risk management a critical strategic priority.

As for all organizations, Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts is not immune to crises. The luxury hospitality sector is particularly exposed to risks related to economic instability, geopolitical tensions, technological change, and shifting consumer expectations. Moreover, because the luxury industry relies heavily on reputation, service quality, and consumer trust, even minor operational or reputational issues can significantly affect brand image.

A relevant example is the 2017 cybersecurity incident involving Sabre Hospitality Solutions, a third-party reservation provider, which exposed sensitive payment data of hotel guests. While the breach did not originate within Four Seasons' internal system, it underscores how third-party risks directly influence the company's stability.

Therefore, the company's ability to anticipate, manage, and respond to both internal vulnerabilities and external risks becomes essential for survival in this multifaceted environment.

This document aims to provide a structured crisis and risk management framework for Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts by identifying the main categories of risks the company can face, evaluating their likelihood and impact, and defining clear governance, communication, and response strategies.

Risk Evaluation

Operating at the top tier of luxury hospitality, Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts faces a broad range of risks, including natural disasters, health crises, cyber threats, and reputational issues.

Since the brand's primary promise is to provide an unmatched experience of safety and comfort, any disruption could jeopardize guest satisfaction and long-term trust.

This manual presents a structured risk-assessment framework designed to help Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts anticipate, evaluate, and respond to crises before they escalate.

Five macro-categories of risk have been identified along two key dimensions: likelihood and impact. Each dimension is rated on a scale from 1 to 5, where 1 indicates the lowest level and 5 the highest.

For each category, the relevant stakeholders are mapped, and strategic priorities are established. The resulting Risk Matrix visualizes where each threat sits in terms of urgency, allowing the Crisis Management Team to allocate resources and communication efforts accordingly.

Health and Safety

Risk	Potential trigger	Stakeholders involved	Likelihood (1-5)	Impact (1-5)
Poisoned food	Wrong food protocol application	Guests, employees, health authorities	5	5
Structural failures	Bad maintenance causing collapse in building areas, systems failures (e.g., hydric s.)	Guests, employees, authorities, media	2	5
Individual crisis	Individual behaviour, parties	Famous guests, authorities, media	1	4
Individual health problems	Developing of diseases during the stay	Guests, employees	3	2

Health and safety risks represent the highest-priority category for Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts. It combines a very high potential impact with a likelihood that ranges from moderate to high, depending on the specific scenario.

Guests and employees are the stakeholders most directly affected by this risk category.

Health and safety risks demand the most rigorous preventive protocols and the fastest crisis-response procedures, as any failure here has immediate, tangible consequences for human life and the brand's reputation.

Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts' response to COVID-19, launching the "Lead With Care" program in partnership with Johns Hopkins Medicine, exemplifies how a health and safety crisis can be transformed into a demonstration of brand values if properly managed.

Natural disasters

Risk	Potential triggers	Stakeholders involved	Likelihood (1-5)	Impact (1-5)
Threat to structures integrity and guests' safety	Hurricanes	Civil protection, health authorities & infrastructure, local authorities, media, guests, employees	2 (general) 4 (tropical areas)	4
Threat to structures integrity and guests' safety	Earthquakes	Civil protection, health authorities & infrastructure, local authorities, media, guests, employees	2 (general) 4 (seismic areas)	5
Threat to structures integrity and guests' safety	Tsunami	Civil protection, health authorities & infrastructure, local authorities, media, guests, employees	1 (general) 3 (tropical areas)	5
Threat to structures integrity and guests' safety	Fires	Civil protection, health authorities & infrastructure, local authorities, media, guests, employees	3	5

The impact of natural disasters is consistently high, while their likelihood varies considerably depending on the geographic location of each facility. Hurricanes in the Caribbean, earthquakes in seismically active zones such as Turkey and Japan, tsunamis in tropical coastal areas, and wildfires in regions such as Hawaii all represent concrete, documented threats to structural integrity and guests' safety.

The stakeholders involved extend beyond the property itself to include civil protection agencies, local health infrastructures, government authorities, and the media.

Because many properties of the group are located in naturally spectacular destinations, this category requires continuous close coordination with local emergency services.

The brand's activation of the "Golden Rule Relief Fund" following the 2023 disasters in Maui, Turkey, and Morocco illustrates how a coordinated, human-centred response can reinforce institutional credibility even in the most adverse circumstances.

Security and Crime

Risk	Potential trigger	Stakeholders involved	Likelihood (1-5)	Impact (1-5)
Privacy violation	Paparazzi introduction	VIP guests, media	4	2
Theft	Thieves violating the structure to steal valuable goods	Guests, employees, authorities, media	2	3
Terroristic attacks	Terroristic movements in unsecure areas	Guests, employees, authorities, media	2	4

Security and crime risks have an average impact of 3 and a likelihood that is generally moderate, but higher in destinations that attract high-profile guests or in politically unstable areas. In this category, each risk involves a distinct stakeholder group.

Prevention relies on strict access-control procedures, close collaboration with local authorities, and discreet but highly effective security protocols that preserve the sense of exclusivity and freedom that Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts' guests expect.

Cybersecurity and Digital Threats

Risk	Potential trigger	Stakeholders involved	Likelihood (1-5)	Impact (1-5)
Personal data stealing (bank accounts, identities, etc.)	Cyber attack	Guests, company (GDPR violation), employees, authorities, media, IT department	3	4
IT systems failure	IT system malfunction, cyber attack	Guests, employees, authorities, IT department	2	3

Cybersecurity and digital threats represent a growing category of risk with a medium impact and a moderate likelihood, reflecting the increasing sophistication of external attacks targeting the hospitality sector.

The stakeholders affected by this risk category are guests, the company's IT department, data-protection authorities, and the media.

Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts' own experience of the 2016-17 Sabre SynXis breach, which exposed thousands of payment records and led to a class action in the United States, makes this category with direct precedent.

Reputational and Ethical Risks

Risk	Potential trigger	Stakeholders involved	Likelihood (1-5)	Impact (1-5)
Unethical staff behaviours	Violation of company's ethical protocol, scandals	Guests, employees, media	2	4
ESG violations	Human rights violations, unethical economic investments	Employees, media, local authorities, human rights authorities, company, public opinion	2	5

Reputational and ethical risks are characterized by a high potential impact and a relatively low-to-moderate likelihood. The threats here are less tangible but potentially more lasting.

The stakeholders affected range from employees and the public to human rights organizations, media, and investors.

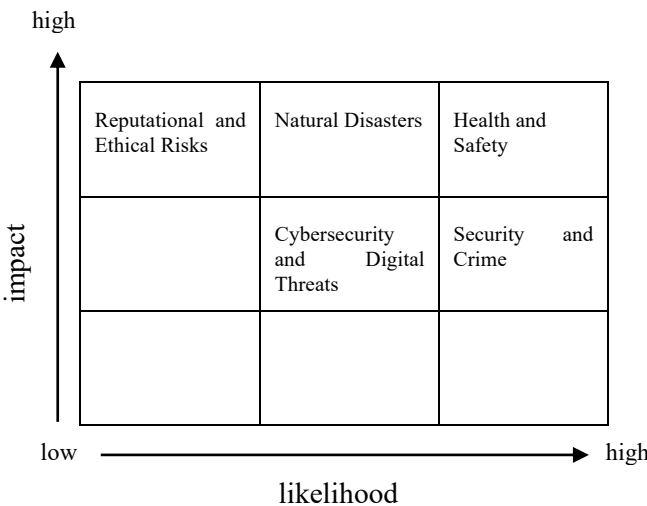
Risk matrix

The Risk Matrix plots the five categories mentioned above on a two-dimensional grid, where the horizontal axis measures the likelihood and the vertical axis the impact.

Categories that fall in the top-right quadrant (high likelihood, high impact) require immediate and continuous investment in crisis preparedness. Categories in the top-left quadrant (low likelihood, high impact) demand solid contingency plans even though their probability is lower. The bottom-right quadrant (high likelihood, low impact) calls for efficient operational procedures that prevent minor incidents from escalating

Based on the scores assigned in this analysis, as shown in the grid below this paragraph, Health and Safety and Natural Disasters occupy the critical top-right/top-center zones, while Cybersecurity sits at a medium-high level.

Reputational and Ethical risks, despite their lower likelihood, remain in the high-impact zone due to the brand’s positioning.



Crisis Governance: Team & Escalation Procedures

This section constitutes the operational core of the Four Seasons Hotel and Resorts Preparedness Manual. It defines the internal governance structure that will be activated in the event of a crisis, establishing clear lines of authority, responsibility, and communication.

Effective crisis governance depends on two interdependent pillars: a well-defined Crisis Management Team (CMT) with unambiguous roles, and a robust escalation framework that ensures the right people are informed at the right time.

Crisis Management Team (CMT)

The Crisis Management Team (CMT) is the central decision-making body activated whenever a significant threat to the organization, its guests, employees, or reputation is identified.

The CMT operates across all Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts and is structured into two levels: a Corporate-level CMT (C-CMT) and a Property-level CMT (P-CMT). The former provides overarching guidance, resource allocation, and reputational management, while the latter handles pragmatic responses and immediate stakeholder communication.

The dual-level structure ensures that crises are managed with both strategic oversight and local operational awareness.

Corporate-level Crisis Management Team (C-CMT)

Role	Title/Function	Key Responsibilities
CMT Chair	President & CEO (Alejandro Reynal)	- Ultimate decision-making authority - Approves crisis response strategy - Leads communication to the Board of Directors and major stakeholders
Chief Communications Officer (CCO)	SVP, Corporate Communications (Marc Speichert)	- Oversees all external and internal messaging - Coordinates with media - Approves all public statements and holding positions
Chief Operations Officer (COO)	SVP, Global Operations (Rainer Stampfer)	- Directs operational response across all properties - Coordinates with regional VPs - Ensures business continuity
Chief Legal Officer (CLO)	General Counsel (Sarah Cohen)	- Provides legal guidance

		- Manages regulatory notifications - Oversees litigation risk and insurance claims
Chief People Officer (CPO)	SVP, Human Resources (Keisha Smith)	- Manages employee welfare - Mental health support and HR implications of the crisis
Chief Security Officer (CSO)	VP, Safety & Security	- Coordinates physical security response - Liaises with law enforcement and emergency services
Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	EVP (Allison Keppy)	- Authorises emergency expenditures - Manages financial exposure and insurance recovery
Digital & Social Media Lead	Director, Digital Communications	- Monitors online sentiment - Manages social media channels and dark site activation
IT & Cyber Lead	VP, Information Technology (Sudhakar Veluru)	- Manages cybersecurity incidents - Ensures data integrity and system resilience

Property-level Crisis Management Team (P-CMT)

Each Four Seasons property maintains its own Property-level Crisis Management Team (P-CMT), comprising local functional leaders and senior staff.

It serves as the initial line of defense during a crisis, handling all immediate on-site actions before involving the company. However, once a crisis is confirmed, the P-CMT escalates directly to Corporate CMT at the global headquarters to ensure a coordinated response at both the property and organizational levels.

Role	Property function	Key responsibilities
Incident Commander	General manager	- Leads on-site response - Primary liaison to the C-CMT - Makes immediate operational decisions - Activates the P-CMT
Operations Lead	Director of Operations / Rooms Division Manager	- Coordinates evacuation, property logistics, vendor management, and resource mobilisation

Guest Relations Lead	Direct of Guest Experience	- Manages guest communication and welfare - Coordinates relocation if needed - Handles VIP guests
HR & Staff Welfare Lead	HR manager (Property)	- Handles staff communication, mental health support, shift coverage, and disciplinary matters
Security Lead	Chief Engineer / Head of Security	- Implements physical security protocols - Liaises with local authorities - Manages access control
Communications Liaison	PR Manager (Property)	- Executes local media relations under direction of the CCO - Manages on-site press enquiries
Finance Lead	Financial Controller	- Manages emergency procurement - Tracks financial impact - Processes insurance documentation

Escalation Procedures

A structured escalation framework is essential to ensure that emerging threats are identified, assessed, and communicated to the right level of authority without delay.

In line with best practices in luxury hotel crisis management, the proposed escalation model for Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts operates on a three-tier system, moving from property-level awareness to full corporate crisis activation. The speed and scale of escalation depend on the severity of the incident as assessed against the thresholds defined below.

Activation Thresholds & Alert Levels

All incidents are classified into one of three alert levels, which determine the scope of CMT activation and the urgency of the response.

Each level triggers a distinct set of protocols, notification requirements, and resource allocations, ensuring that the organization's response remains proportionate to the severity of the situation and protective of both guest safety and brand integrity.

The three levels are defined as follows:

Alert Level	Definition	Examples	CMT Activation
LEVEL 1 Monitor	Emerging situations requiring awareness and precautionary monitoring. No immediate threat to guests, staff or operations.	> Minor social media complaint trending > Small-scale food intolerance complaint > Local unrest nearby (not at property)	Property Duty manager notified P-CMT on standby
LEVEL 2 Respond	Confirmed incident with potential reputational, operational or safety implications. Contained but requires coordinated response.	> Guest injury requiring hospitalization > Data breach affecting <500 records > Staff misconduct allegation > Local media enquiry	P-CMT activated General Manager leads C-CMT briefed within 2 hours
LEVEL 3 Crisis	Severe, fast-moving crisis with significant threat to life, major reputational damage, or multi-property impact.	> Guest fatality > Terrorist incident > Major data breach > Natural disaster affecting property > Reputational crisis in national/global media	C-CMT fully activated CEO leads All stakeholders mobilized immediately

Internal Reporting Channels

In line with the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, all Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts employees must report any unusual event or emerging risk to their General Manager, Regional Vice President, or HR Director.

To reinforce crisis detection across all properties, this manual proposes four additional mechanisms:

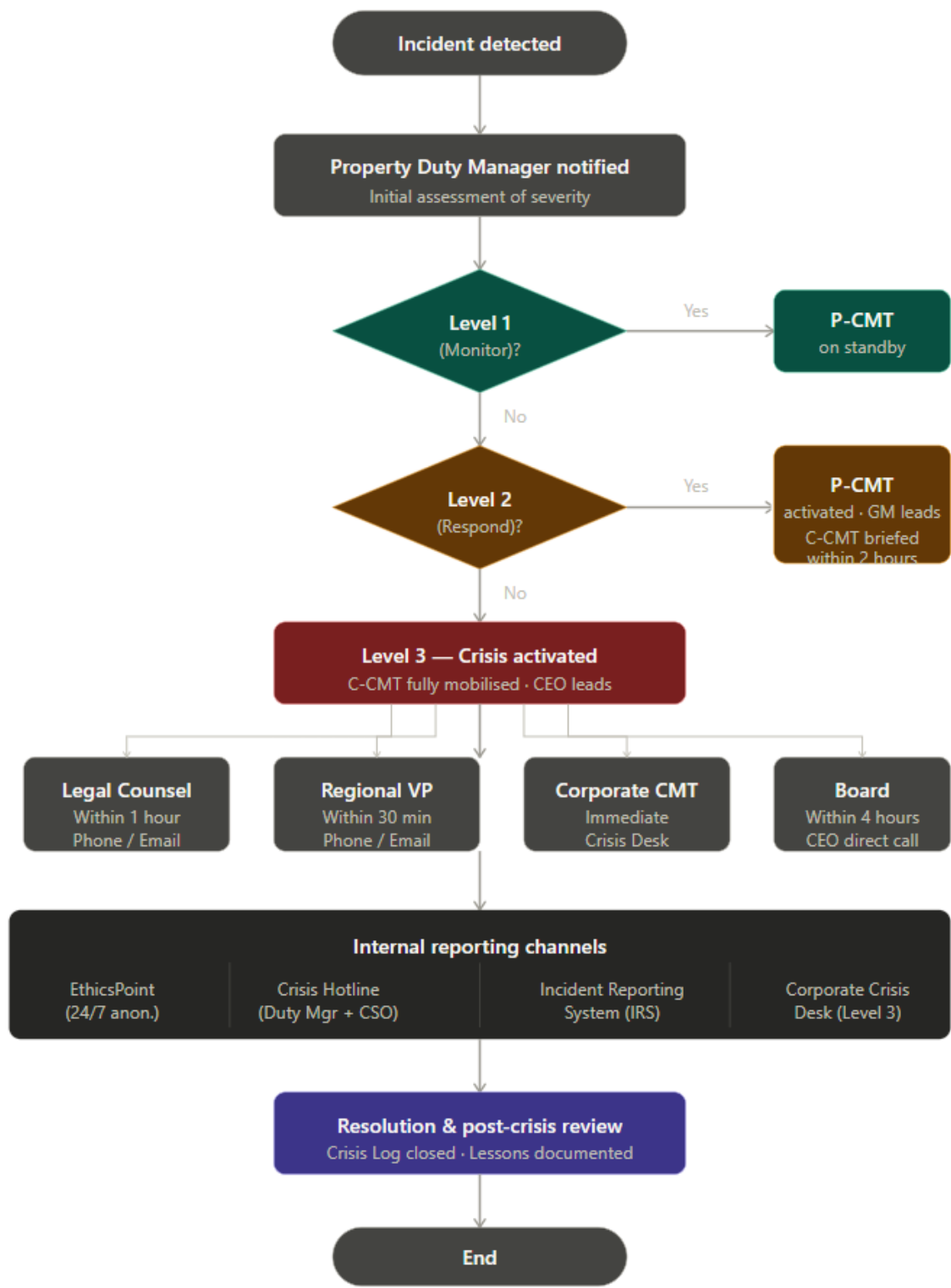
- EthicsPoint, the company's official external platform available 24/7 by phone or online for anonymous reporting
- a Crisis Hotline, an internal 24/7 line routed to the Duty Manager and Chief Security Officer
- an Incident Reporting System (IRS), a digital intranet portal for logging non-urgent situations, automatically flagged to the General Manager and the relevant department head
- a Corporate Crisis Desk, activated exclusively for Level 3 crises, connecting the General Manager directly to the CMT Chair and the CCO

Who must be informed & When

The notification matrix below defines the minimum required notifications at each alert level. Notifications must be completed within the timeframes specified, with confirmation logged in the Crisis Log.

Stakeholder	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Method
Property Duty Manager	Immediate	Immediate	Immediate	Phone / In person
General Manager	Within 30 min	Immediate	Immediate	Phone
HR Manager (Property)	As needed	Within 1 hour	Immediate	Phone
Chief Security Officer	As needed	Immediate	Immediate	Phone / Crisis Hotline
Regional Vice President	Not required	Within 2 hours	Within 30 minutes	Phone / Email
Corporate CMT (C-CMT)	Not required	Within 2 hours	Immediate	Crisis Desk / Phone
Legal Counsel	Not required	Within 4 hours	Within 1 hour	Phone / Email
Board of Directors	Not required	Not required	Within 4 hours	CEO direct call
Regulatory Authorities	Not required	As legally required	As legally required	Formal written notice
Media / Public	Not required	Via CCO only	Via CCO only	Holding statement

Crisis Escalation Flowchart



Response templates

Food Disaster Risk (Health and Safety)

Company Holding Statement	<i>“We are aware of reports concerning a potential food safety incident at [Four Seasons facility] and we are treating the matter with the utmost seriousness. Our immediate priority is the health and wellbeing of our guests and employees. Please note that, as a precautionary measure, we have suspended operations in the affected kitchen areas while conducting a thorough sanitization process and a full review of food handling procedures. We are fully cooperating with local health authorities to determine the source of the problem, while providing support to any guest in need. Further updates will be provided through official communication channels when confirmed information becomes available.”</i>
Key Messages	➤ Guest safety comes first The health and safety of the guests and employees remain the highest priority of the company. All decisions are being guided by established emergency response protocols. ➤ Immediate response measures activated Upon receiving reports of illness, the company immediately isolates potentially affected food items, suspends relevant kitchen operations, and initiates a deep sanitization and audit process. ➤ Strict food safety standards Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts maintain rigorous hygiene and food handling procedures, including continuous temperature monitoring and mandatory safety compliance checks across all food service operations. ➤ Collaboration with Health Authorities Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts is working closely and transparently with local public health officials and independent specialists to investigate the situation and verify all findings.

Q&A	Q1: What caused the food safety incident? A1: The investigation is currently ongoing. We are reviewing kitchen procedures, supplier records, and food handling logs in collaboration with health authorities to identify the exact cause. Q2: What support is being provided to affected guests? A2: We are offering immediate medical assistance, alongside a dedicated support service. We are committed to ensure affected individuals appropriate care and assistance. Q3: Is the hotel still operating safely? A3: Yes. As a precaution, operations linked to the affected area have been suspended. All other food services remain continued, while subjected to safety inspections. Q4: What measures are being taken to prevent similar incidents? A4: We are conducting a full operational review, reinforcing staff training and implementing additional monitoring and verification procedures across food preparation and storage processes.
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Natural Disaster Risk

Company Holding Statement	<i>“Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts is currently responding to the impacts of [specific natural disaster]. Emergency response protocols were activated immediately, and on-site teams are working closely with local emergency authorities to assess the situation accordingly. Essential services are continued, if possible. Further updates will be provided through official communication channels when confirmed information becomes available.”</i>
Key messages	➤ Safety is the primary priority Protecting guests, employees, and local communities is the focus of every operational decision during the emergency response. ➤ Preparedness and rapid response Emergency protocols were activated immediately. ➤ Continuous coordination with authorities The company is working in close collaboration with civil protection agencies, engineers, and emergency responders to ensure all actions align with official safety guidance. ➤ Transparent and ongoing communication Verified updates are being shared regularly through official communication channels.

Q&A	Q1: Is the hotel structure safe after the disaster? A1: Initial inspections indicate that the property remains structurally stable. Comprehensive assessments by the authorities in charge are ongoing. Q2: Does the hotel have sufficient emergency supplies? A2: Yes. Emergency preparedness plans include backup supplies for food, water, medical kits, and essential utilities to support guests and employees during this kind of situations. Q3: How are families and stakeholders being informed? A3: We have established a dedicated communication channel through which we continuously send updates to people involved. Q4: What happens for affected guests? A4: Our team is actively assisting guests with accommodation arrangements, transportation supports, and ongoing care while recovery and safety assessments continue.
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Communication tools & operational materials

Press release and holding statements templates

A press release template is a pre-written model used to communicate official statements to the media, the public, and external stakeholders.

The template features a fixed structure with blanks to be filled with details of each specific crisis. This ensures the company a quick response that is consistent with its values, thereby reducing the likelihood of committing errors under pressure.

The company uses the template when the crisis reaches level 2 or 3; otherwise, other communications tools are employed.

The skeleton of the press release contains a neutral title, followed by a factual statement that reports precisely what happened. Moreover, a sentence explaining the actions the company is taking to overcome the crisis is of fundamental importance.

Stakeholders, too, must be informed of the actions they need to take to help the company overcome the crisis as clearly as possible. Therefore, a statement should be dedicated to advising stakeholders on their next moves.

The press release should end with the company's promise to fix the issue as quickly as possible, along with useful contact information. The company's spokesperson should sign the document.

Despite being a standardized template, the press release should be very thorough, precise, and rich in giving clear, updated information.

The press release template is not the only tool the company has for quick communication with relevant stakeholders during a crisis. The company also drafts a holding statement template in advance.

A holding statement is a brief, initial description of a crisis used in its early phases, when information is still incomplete. The purpose of this communication tool is both to inform the relevant stakeholders that the company is aware of the critical situation and to reassure them that actions are being taken to overcome it.

To ensure a quick response, the holding statement should be distributed within about 30 minutes of the crisis occurring. This tool is often used before the official, more complete press release.

Both tools work together to communicate a message; therefore, instructions should be coherent throughout, and the style of the communication should be consistent. The tone of voice should be calm, not dramatic, factual, and transparent, avoiding the communication of unverified information. The message should convey that the relevant stakeholders are Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts' top priority. The company should not be depicted as trying to salvage only its own reputation.

It is also advisable to translate the templates into the five main operating languages – English, Chinese, Arabic, French, and Italian – to ensure more localized communication.

This is a general structure that all crisis templates should follow. However, more specific templates should be drafted for each of the 5 macro-crisis categories that Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts faces.

Operational instructions should be provided to ensure the correct use of these two tools and coherence in the crisis management.

For level 2 and 3 crises, the C-CMT decides within the first few minutes after the crisis breaks whether to use the holding statement template.

If the template is used, a briefing needs to be prepared and sent to the C-CMT designated spokesperson, who then fills in the blanks in the model with the right information.

The document undergoes revision by legal officers and the CLO, CCO, and CMT before being published on the designated channels.

After the holding statement publication, the C-CMT takes time to monitor media response and social media sentiment and gather more precise information. A discussion on how to write the official press release should take place.

Once the drafted press release has undergone legal checks and has been approved for publication, it can be released on the dedicated platforms. After that, it is advisable to have a dedicated 24/7 call center to address stakeholders' concerns.

Moreover, the company needs to monitor media coverage and social media sentiment to assess whether changes to the message are needed while the crisis is still ongoing.

When the crisis ends, all official communications must be stored in the crisis log for further analysis and discussion.

Internal communication template and spokesperson briefing sheet

It is important for Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts to have internal communication templates to follow to ensure coherence at both the property and corporate levels. The company needs to be ready for what to say and how to handle different stakeholders once the crisis breaks out. The template standardizes communication among properties and favors coordination, which is essential to guarantee coherence.

The initial 24 hours following the crisis are crucial for Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts.

The designated spokesperson for the company should be prepared to communicate verified information in a standardized, coherent way following an internal briefing sheet. Moreover, at the property level, employees should follow a guest dialogue guide to maintain coordination in the messages the company delivers.

The briefing sheet is a template for the spokesperson responsible for issuing further statements to the media, authorities, and other external stakeholders.

The skeleton of the template emphasizes certified facts and provides key general messages to be repeated. It also provides guidance on which tone to use, what to say, and what to avoid saying. Additionally, it includes tips on how to avoid tricky questions.

The briefing sheet is useful for ensuring each spokesperson's messages remain consistent with corporate communications. At the corporate level, either the CEO or the CCO should be appointed to this role, while the general manager is best suited at the property level.

A guest dialogue is a tool used to reassure guests and prevent the situation from escalating. It is provided to all staff members who are in contact with clients during a crisis.

This template includes a short list of approved response lines, escalation contacts, and guidelines on when to escalate.

The briefing sheet template is to be used in the event of a level 2 or 3 crisis. For smaller, property-level 1 crises, a meeting with the property general manager and facility employees should be sufficient to instruct staff on how to handle the crisis and communicate with guests.

Once a level 2 or 3 crisis arises, the C-CMT writes the holding statement, notifies each property general manager, and begins preparing the corporate briefing sheet. It should be translated into the five main operating languages for better understanding. The corporate briefing sheet serves as a guideline for P-CMT communication at the property level.

Both teams should remain in contact in case of an unexpected crisis event that requires the company to adapt the scripts.

Every script and modification, both at the property and corporate levels, should be archived in the crisis log.

Social media response guidelines

These guidelines are rules for communicating on social media during a crisis.

Social media is extremely useful during a crisis, as it enables the company to communicate directly with the public in the shortest timeframe possible. In addition, the tone is warmer and more comforting than that of holding statements and press releases. Nonetheless, coherence among the different communication tools must be ensured.

Every message communicated on social media should fall into one of several response categories, such as questions, accusations, misinformation, complaints, and insults, to name a few. Each category has guidelines on how to reply and the general structure of the response.

Moreover, the framework contains information on publishing authority, message content, response timing, and post or comment deletion.

Regardless of its category, each message should maintain the same tone of voice and convey facts in a calm, empathic way. A link to official sources, such as FAQs, corporate press releases, or contact information, is recommended.

Moreover, no promotional content should be posted during a level 2 or 3 crisis, as it could give the impression that the company is not giving the crisis events sufficient importance.

As with every other communication tool, all posts and social media messages are to be stored in the crisis log.

Social media responses are used both at the property and corporate levels.

When the crisis reaches only level 1, smaller social media responses are drafted at the property level. This usually happens for minor complaints, general questions, and milder matters.

In the case of a level 2 or 3 crisis, social media messages need approval from the monitoring team, the digital & social media lead, and the C-CMT before being published.

Media monitoring framework

It is a framework designed to observe and monitor online conversations during a crisis. This tool is vital because even minor changes can spread rapidly and become difficult for the company to manage.

Monitoring online conversations is of paramount importance, as it enables the company to observe crisis developments, stakeholders' sentiments and doubts, and whether the public holds it responsible for the crisis.

This practice should not only be done during a crisis, but also as a preventive measure to scan the environment.

Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts should not limit its monitoring only to traditional media. Instead, it should also look for hints in blogs, forums, booking sites, OTAs, and review platforms.

The media monitoring framework should include keywords related to different crisis types to be screened and channels to be searched. Moreover, guidelines regarding the teams, the dedicated software, and the rhythms to report the information should be provided.

Finally, there should be escalation rules to indicate precisely to whom the information should be passed to be further analysed, classified, evaluated, and sent to the right response team.

As such, media monitoring is a communication tool to be used alongside other templates to ensure coherence and completeness of the company's response.

Stakeholders contact list

It is an updated list of stakeholders' contacts. Every stakeholder who needs to be informed during a crisis should be included on this list, along with their relevant information. In this way, in the occurrence of a crisis, time is not wasted in searching for the right contacts.

For every stakeholder, it is useful to list: the category and the name of its spokesperson; the role; the contacts (phone number and/or email); the preferred channel to use; the priority level; the language and the time zone; when to contact them, and within how long after the crisis breaks.

The classification of the stakeholders should be very thorough and precise. Traditional stakeholders, such as guests, employees, and shareholders, are juxtaposed with external ones, such as travel agents, government entities, tourist organizations, and the media.

There should be both a printed list, kept in a corporate safe, and an online one stored in the cloud, overseen by the IT & Cyber Lead. They should be updated regularly and archived in the crisis log.

It is important to note that the company should collect the information necessary to protect and support stakeholders during a crisis while respecting and valuing their privacy. This is particularly important for guests, but the same principle should apply to all stakeholders on the contact list to ensure coherence.

For this reason, the list must remain confidential to authorized staff and be archived properly.

Crisis log template

The crisis log is a chronological record of all events that occur during a crisis.

It is extremely important that every company accurately tracks any strategic communication moves implemented during that period.

The purpose is to evaluate the effectiveness of the crisis response and facilitate further investigation.

Post-crisis evaluations are the insights the company gains from an accurate analysis of the material in the crisis log. Upon them, implementations should be carried out to avoid future mistakes.

Four Seasons Hotels and Resorts should employ this tool at every level of a crisis.

The template should clearly describe every decision, specifying who made and approved each one. The same goes for every action taken during the crisis and for the effects that the above-mentioned action has produced.

All stakeholders who are contacted, informed, or involved in any way, during the crisis period must be registered in the crisis log, along with the channels employed to reach them.

Finally, the company's whereabouts during every stage of the crisis must be registered.

The content of the log should be written in a clear, precise way and updated in real time. A dedicated person, a log keeper, is appointed at each property to check at the end of each day that the information has been logged correctly. Information is then shared by the property log keeper with the CCO and the rest of the team. At the end of the crisis, the C-CMT analyses the entire crisis log to make post-crisis evaluations.

It is advisable to have both a printed and an online version of the log for the same reasons as the stakeholder list.